



## NORTH KOREA

North Korea is an independent communist country, but since the break up of the Soviet Union it has lost many of its trading partners and is now very poor. However, the country has a good education system and a high literacy rate. Schooling is free and compulsory for all children for 10 years.

## SOUTH KOREA

South Korea is a democratic nation with a thriving electronics and machinery industry. A quarter of the population lives in or near the capital city, Seoul. The Internet developed quickly in South Korea and today almost 90 percent of the population use it, with the highest Internet connection speed in the world.

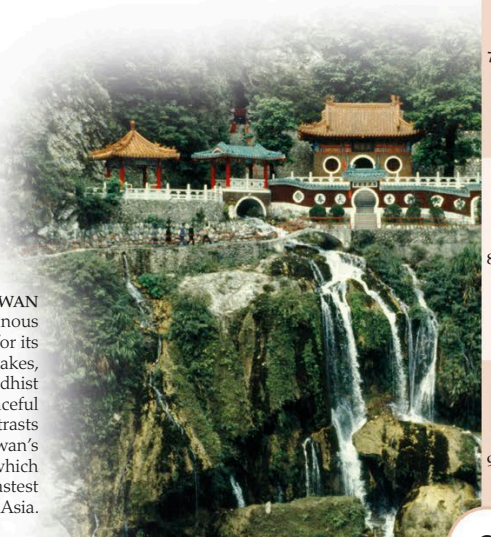


*The majority of the Chinese population lives in just 15 percent of the total land area.*



## MODERN SHANGHAI

China's largest city is Shanghai. More than 23 million people live in this wealthy east-coast port. International trade has transformed Shanghai's skyline, which is now crowded with high-rise buildings and modern shopping malls. The center of town still has some old western-style buildings that have survived from the days before the revolution.



## BEAUTY OF TAIWAN

Taiwan's mountainous countryside is famous for its natural beauty, scenic lakes, and many ornate Buddhist temples. This peaceful environment contrasts sharply with Taiwan's capital city, Taipei, which is one of the fastest growing cities in Asia.

## Bicycle factory



## CHINESE INDUSTRY

After the revolutionary leader Mao Zedong died in 1976, China's economy opened up. Industry and manufacturing was encouraged and today China plays a big part in the global economy. Many people are moving into cities for better-paid jobs.